



PUBLISHING AGREEMENT – 07.10.2026

Prepared for Jeff Church (Author)

By Credible.Ink (Publishing Partner)

Publisher of Record: Church Family Productions

Project: The Art of the Startup (working title)

PROJECT SCOPE

Credible Ink will provide complete design, editorial, and production services for a 6×9 business book published under the Church Family Productions imprint, available in paperback, case laminate hardcover, dust jacket hardcover, and Kindle formats on Amazon KDP and IngramSpark. This agreement covers three scoped service areas as detailed below.

DELIVERABLES

Base Publishing Package — \$6,500

- Cover design for all publication formats, front and back (paperback, case laminate hardcover, dust jacket hardcover, eBook thumbnail)
- Interior layout and typesetting — 6×9 print-ready PDFs for paperback and hardcover; reflowable EPUB for Kindle
- Image and chart placement (approximately 20 items), including black-and-white conversion and image optimization; EPUB text-link alternates for QR codes
- Basic proofread — spelling, punctuation, and consistency pass
- Keyword and category research; metadata optimization
- Optimized book description copy
- Guidance on Amazon KDP and IngramSpark account setup and onboarding; assistance with file upload to both platforms
- Proof ordering and review
- Launch calendar guidance
- Social media assets (launch essentials)
- Final packaged files (print PDFs, EPUB, native source files)

Expanded Title & Cover Exploratory — \$1,250

- Title research and development across two title directions
- Three cover concepts per title direction (six concepts total)
- 1–2 rounds of revisions on the selected direction

Editorial Initial Read — \$500

- Full manuscript review by an external reviewer with recommendations, with particular attention to the opening chapters
- Recommendations for any additional editing will be provided separately; hands-on editorial work is not included in this service

FEE & PAYMENT TERMS

Base Publishing Package: \$6,500

Expanded Title & Cover Exploratory: \$1,250

Editorial Initial Read: \$500

Total: \$8,250

2 installments:

- \$4,125 — due at signing
- \$4,125 — due at delivery of publish-ready files

All deliverables remain the property of Credible.Ink until full payment is received. Payment is accepted by debit card, credit card, or ACH. An invoice will follow under separate email.

TIMELINE

- Kickoff: July 9, 2026 (complete)
- Final manuscript from author, including back-cover endorsements: July 31, 2026
- First cover concepts: July 31, 2026
- Full interior layout: August 14, 2026
- Physical proof: August 28, 2026
- Target launch: Early September 2026

The manuscript is considered locked at layout. Timeline is contingent on receipt of the final manuscript by July 31, 2026, with a grace period through August 7, 2026. Delays beyond August 7 may shift the launch window. QR code destinations and live links are required before final file delivery.

PRODUCTION & REVISION POLICY

Revision rounds included: six cover concepts across two title directions; 1–2 rounds of cover revisions on the selected direction; 1–2 rounds of interior edits.

Changes requested after approvals, or revisions that substantially alter approved content, layout, or design direction beyond the included rounds, may require additional time and may be billed at \$110/hour, subject to author approval prior to work commencing.

Once the manuscript is approved for layout, it is considered locked. Substantive changes after this point may affect timeline, scope, or cost.

USE OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

Client acknowledges and agrees that Service Provider may utilize artificial intelligence ("AI") tools and technologies in connection with the performance of certain services under this Agreement. Such use may include, without limitation, research assistance, data organization, document drafting, editing, summarization, analysis, content generation, and other administrative or professional support functions.

Service Provider shall remain solely responsible for all work product delivered to Client and shall exercise independent professional judgment in reviewing, evaluating, modifying, and approving any output generated through AI tools before it is relied upon or provided to Client. The use of AI tools shall not diminish Service Provider's obligations under this Agreement.

Service Provider will take reasonable measures to protect Client confidential information and, to the extent practicable, will avoid disclosing confidential or proprietary information to AI platforms that do not provide appropriate security and confidentiality protections. Client consents to Service Provider's use of AI tools in accordance with the terms of this provision.

WHAT IS NOT INCLUDED

To avoid ambiguity, the following services are not included in this agreement unless explicitly added in writing:

- Audiobook production
- Marketing, PR, and publicity
- Author website
- Ongoing platform management after launch
- Guaranteed sales performance or rankings
- Any hands-on editorial work beyond the initial read (scoped and quoted separately)

Any work requested outside the defined scope may require a separate agreement or additional fees.

OWNERSHIP & RIGHTS

Upon full payment, the Author retains 100% ownership of the final book files and creative assets produced under this agreement, including interior layouts, cover design, and source files. No rights are withheld.

Credible Ink retains the limited right to display the work for portfolio and promotional purposes only.

The book is published under the Church Family Productions imprint. All intellectual property rights, royalties, and platform accounts remain with the Author.

AGREEMENT

Payment of the initial invoice constitutes acceptance of the terms outlined in this agreement.